range of issues with equal confidence. It is also a greater contributor to solutions, regional or global. This marks its emergence as *vishwa mitra*, a partner of the world that is making a greater difference with each passing year. The New Delhi G20 Summit not only affirmed our ability to shape the global agenda but also underlined that other nations value their relationship with us as well.

The problem with a purely detached examination is that it is unable to convey the full flavour of this transformation. Moreover, it could suggest that there was an inevitability about it, thereby neglecting the power of ideas and the importance of leadership. A truly accurate understanding of the journey we have been through and the possibilities that await us requires a personalized picture as well. Some of it involves the granular aspects of the diplomatic process, but much emanates from the personal views and thoughts of Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi. So, after some hesitation, I decided to prefix this book with a preface that would give the reader a glimpse of how policies were formulated and decisions taken.

My personal acquaintance with Narendra Modi began in 2011, when I was Ambassador in China and he was the Chief Minister (CM) of Gujarat. While awaiting his visit, I was struck by the meticulousness of preparations and his interest to assess China's progress in different fields. It was apparent to me even then that he envisaged developments in both India and China in terms of civilizational resurgence. What also stood out was his request for a political briefing since he did not wish to deviate from what were national positions while abroad. Terrorism and sovereignty understandably were the focus, given the agenda of our ties.

It was also my first exposure to a working style that emphasized comprehensive briefings and constant feedback. My cumulative impression was one of strong nationalism, great purposefulness and deep attention to detail. His openness to the ideas and experiences of others was also manifest. Those few days spent together allowed me to express my own thoughts on comparative modernization in Asia and gauge his own views. He was clearly impressed by the economic and technology advancements of Japan but also by their social cohesion and cultural pride. I also have a recollection of him speaking well about the leadership quality of Lee Kuan Yew. It was no surprise that he made it a point to attend his funeral later on in 2015. Occasionally, I have reflected on this first encounter because there were pointers there about his strong views on terrorism, his forthright